
RAUL BLANCO VAZQUEZ

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Final year Computer Science student at the University of Leicester, maintaining a First-Class academic record with hands-on experience in cybersecurity and software development. Certified in network security, incident detection, and threat mitigation through the Google Cybersecurity Certificate, with practical skills in Linux, Python automation, and SIEM tools. Eager to grow professionally in cybersecurity, contributing to threat detection, incident response, and the digital resilience of organisations.

SKILLS

- **Cybersecurity:** Network Security, Incident Detection and Response, SIEM Tools, Threat Mitigation, Log Analysis, Python Automation, Firewall Concepts
- **Programming Languages:** Python, Java, HTML/CSS/JavaScript
- **Tools & Platforms:** Git, Gitlab, Linux, SQL
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** PyTorch, Spring Boot, OpenCV, Firebase, Pandas, scikit-learn

CERTIFICATES

Google Cybersecurity Certificate, *Google Career Certificates* - 10/2024:

Network security, incident detection and response, hands-on experience in risk identification, threat mitigation, automation with Python, use of Linux, SQL and SIEM tools.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Deepfake Detection System (Final Year Project): 10/2025 – 04/2026

Developed a threat detection system to identify AI-generated media attacks, implementing forensic analysis pipelines and model-based anomaly detection, using Python, PyTorch, FastAPI, Docker, and computer vision.

- Developed a secure preprocessing pipeline using MTCNN face detection and MediaPipe alignment, processing 14,000+ videos into 447,000+ face images for forensic model training.
- Trained and benchmarked deepfake detection models including XceptionNet, an EfficientNet-B4 ensemble, LSTM temporal modelling, and compression-robust fine-tuning.
- Evaluated robustness across in-the-wild and out-of-family deepfake settings, achieving 91.54% AUC on WildDeepfake and 71.61% AUC on DFDC out-of-family evaluation.

Cloud Infrastructure & Network Security (CO3219): 10/2025-12/2025

Deployed a private cloud on Google Cloud Platform, configuring network security, infrastructure monitoring, and a distributed Kubernetes cluster across 3 availability zones

- Configured VPC firewall rules and network segmentation on GCP, restricting port access to Kubernetes API, kubelet, and consensus ports across a 3-node cluster
- Set up Prometheus and Grafana monitoring stack across 3 VMs for real-time observability of CPU, memory, and network metrics

COMPETITIONS & AWARDS

1st Place - Hackathon Capital One - 2024: Built *Campus Essentials Locator*, a web app helping students find campus resources. Won 1st place among competing university teams.

3rd Place - Hackathon IBM - 2025: Developed *Study Buddy*, a study session platform built with Java 17, Spring Boot, Firebase, and Vanilla JavaScript. Features included smart session matching by module/year, real-time in-session chat, a join request system, and user ratings - deployed on Railway.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (Honours): Computer Science, Expected First-Class in 06/2026

University of Leicester - United Kingdom

- **Foundations of Cybersecurity – 90%:** Studied public key cryptography and modern cryptosystems. Implemented secure network applications and analyzed internet protocols and attack vectors.
- **Databases and Domain Modelling – 83%:** Practical experience with relational databases and MySQL, web development using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, and understanding of database security issues including unauthorized access and data loss prevention.
- **Software Architecture and Systems Development – 86%:** Full-stack web application development with Spring Boot in an agile environment, from requirements gathering to deployment.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Founder and President, 08/2024 - Ongoing

University of Leicester Salsa Society

- Founded and scaled the society to hundreds of members, organised weekly events with a 90% participation rate. Increased event attendance through promotion, targeted outreach, managing all communications, scheduling, and stakeholder coordination.

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native, **Galician:** Native, **English:** Native